

OE3C Planning Meeting 3

Date: 17 Nov 2025

Location: CRN 527/Online

Time: 10:08 – 11:29 AM

Attendees: Lyllian Corbin, Alex Wilder, Kiyoko Gotanda, Reem Mahamoud, Rasa Khosrowshahli, Wylan Clitheroe, Sarah Hein, Nicholas Benton, Matthew Summerville, Lauren Nesbitt, Harry Kumbhani, Madelaine Legault, Miriam Richards

Chairs: Kiyoko Gotanda, Alex Wilder

Minutes by: Lyllian Corbin

Alex began the meeting at 10:08 AM.

Call to order, meeting recap and theme vote result

- Theme vote result: the conference theme will be “Coexisting Within Nature” (first pick)
- Reminder that Trello contains all to-do lists and important notes

Logo discussion with Lauren

- Logo is complete
 - Cute badger holding windmill with trillium flower; Niagara Falls in background
 - Lauren sent the logo to Alex for review
 - There are different options for the wording/phrase placement
- Kiyoko suggested making the Niagara Falls more horseshoe-shaped to represent Canada's falls
 - Also suggested having a couple of versions with different font styles
- Most people like the 1st logo with typewriter font (i.e. Alex, Lyly, Matt, Kiyoko)
 - The other logo options may also be useful for posters/flyers
- Matt asked for permission to upscale logo digitally for use on social media and website
 - Alex suggested saving different versions of the logo

Website discussion with Rasa

- Changed the website make the branding follow Brock's colours
 - Harry confirmed that the OE3C website was created by Waterloo, Carlton used most of Waterloo's formatting
 - Karen's Waterloo email is on the webpage because she is informed on the history and information on past OE3C's
 - We can put her name in the acknowledgements, with a link to the OE3C github, and remove her email
 - Kiyoko suggested including last year's program on the website for now and other parts can show "coming soon" (e.g., abstract submission, registration, accommodations, etc.)
 - Could use stock photos of Brock for the webpage background
 - Lauren suggested showing the Brock Schmon Tower in the background
 - Matt suggested to change colours of the background and tabs to Brock's colours
 - Confirmed the website should show hotel information with booking code
 - Once we have this information on the website, people can begin booking rooms soon
 - Social media links need to be updated on the website
 - Alex suggested for Rasa contact Justin Steepe for materials and help with website design
 - **Contact:** jsteepe@brocku.ca
 - Suggested choosing a logo font that is on the website to keep the font style consistent
 - Past sponsors can be left off the website for now until we can confirm the sponsors for 2026
 - Need to make the conference schedule easy to find
 - Message subcommittee leads to confirm up-to-date info for the website
 - Dates need to be updated to: April 30th to May 2nd
 - Rasa, Lauren, and Matt can discuss the website design further along with incorporating the logo
- Rasa confirmed they fixed Bluesky account to have an OE3C domain

Keynote discussion with Harry

- It will be difficult to get a speaker from outside of the province due to travel costs
 - Harry suggested getting speakers within Ontario
 - Kiyoko confirmed that past OE3Cs had international speakers
 - Madelaine suggested having Liette Vasseur as a speaker since she's the UNESCO chair
 - Miriam suggested inviting Brock alumni from other universities
 - Harry and Alex responded they are interested in branching out beyond Brock for a broader scope of speakers/topics
- Speaker idea discussion
 - Harry listed ideas in the "keynote ideas" document on Teams
 - Maydianne Andrade
 - Could be the Evolution speaker
 - Fits into multiple spots (we can decide based on what speakers we find)
 - Jesse Popp
 - Chair in indigenous environmental science
 - Andrea Reid
 - Alex suggested holding research-related workshops/outings with this speaker
 - Madelaine and Harry are on board with this idea
 - Lauren suggested the following:
 - Stephen Marshall
 - Wrote keys and textbooks for insects
 - Francine McCarthy
 - Could also include an outing at Crawford Lake
 - Kiyoko agreed to having an outing with Francine
 - She was a plenary speaker for the 2023 GRAMSS FMS GRaD conference
 - Wylan has an idea of someone from the industry – they will reach out to Harry with more information
 - Harry confirmed they will make a poll for the OE3C team to vote on
 - Alex asked for a timeline of this poll
 - Harry will send the poll by next week and will give a deadline for voting
 - Alex asked if we are decided on having additional keynotes or only 3 keynote speakers
 - Kiyoko mentioned that we need to have enough time for all of the keynote talks
 - Harry stated that 3 speakers might be enough
 - Alex suggested searching for speakers beyond biology

Outings/socials discussion with Alex, Madelaine, and Nick

- Madelaine asked for the number of outings we want to have
 - Alex answered that the number will depend on when the outings are
 - We can play with different options
 - Alex suggested having a variety of outings that reaches different interests would be good
 - Margarita is opening a new bar in downtown St. Catharines, she confirmed with Alex that we can have access to that space for outings
 - Harry mentioned that the first day (arrival day) usually has multiple outings and workshops
 - For example, Waterloo had bird banding and tree planting at the university, while school buses took some groups to Cambridge to tour conservation areas
 - This will give everyone an incentive to come earlier and be present for the keynote talk for Day 1
- Nick brought up some of their ideas for workshops
 - Guided tour around the Bruce Trails
 - Have an expert in botany, birds, etc.
 - Wylan mentioned they specialised in making outings knowledgeable (interpretations)
 - Knows how to do the scripts/planning/logistics
- Kiyoko suggested **speaking to Liette for workshops** to learn about wine
 - Alex suggested hosting a wine tasting at Brock's Wine Library
 - People can sign up on their own
 - Tours are free
- Wylan, Nick, and Madelaine might work together to organise the outings

Workshops discussion with Nick

- Currently brainstorming ideas
 - Thinking about workshops that reach all 3 E's and aren't solely focused on nature
 - Nick will discuss their ideas further in a subcommittee meeting
 - Some examples so far include:
 - Coding course
 - GIS
 - Photography workshop with Kiyoko
 - Alex suggested **giving deadlines of when the team should submit workshop and keynote ideas**
 - Alex will organise a shared calendar for OE3C team

- Kiyoko suggested embedding this calendar in the OE3C website too
- Kiyoko suggested to hold a People's Choice Contest so people can submit photos/illustrations
 - Lauren suggested that contestants can do different things and use mixed media (e.g., create sculptures)
 - Kiyoko suggested that we could hold a silent auction for the art submissions
 - Alex agreed to these ideas

Social media discussion with Matt

- Matt will begin announcing on socials now that we have the logo and theme
- Kiyoko suggested to build a following on socials (following/liking accounts and posts)

Grant discussion with Kiyoko and Alex

- Exchange Grant discussion with Kiyoko
 - Went through completeness check
 - Due Dec 1st
 - Will post in the funding channel
 - Given by Brock (goes to ORS)
 - Alex suggested reaching out to Elena for assistance
 - Sarah asked how much the grant is worth
 - Kiyoko confirmed the amount is \$6, 500
- Other grants
 - Kiyoko confirmed that we need to reach out to Elena to apply for VPR discretion funds as soon as possible
 - Alex is working on a sheet for other grants we can apply for
 - Anyone interested in applying for grants can reach out to Alex
 - Sarah and Alex will work on this
 - Kiyoko suggested that the team “divide and conquer” when applying for grants
 - Have a master folder with information about all grants
 - Harry mentioned the 2025 OE3C team got a large grant from the Admin Dean at Waterloo, which helped them pay most of their expenses

Undergrad Representatives

- Wylan Clitheroe
 - Introduction with Wylan
 - Worked with GRAMSS for past events/conferences
 - Interpretation work experience (e.g., guided hikes, art programs, education outreach, social media experience, etc.)
- Cassia Hamilton*
 - Conference planning experience
 - Exhibitions
- Farisa Khan*
 - Student leadership experience

** They have not accepted the invite yet but will be involved in meetings as soon as they do respond*

To-do lists with Alex

- Conference services
 - Will be emailing information about catering and bookings
 - Lillian will need to review and organise these materials
 - Anything money related will go through Sarah (with Alex and Kiyoko cc'd on any emails)
 - Lillian will help with this
 - Reem will be in contact with conference services for registration logistics

Questions/General discussion

- Sarah – list of grants?
 - Spreadsheet is in the Fundraising and Finance channel, has info from Carlton
 - Alex will consolidate the information
 - Kiyoko – some grants have deadlines (e.g., AGA = Dec 5th)
 - Kiyoko will put the Exchange Grant information on Teams
- Reem – contacting conference services?
 - Kiyoko will work with Reem to coordinate/contact conference services
- Nick's questions
 - Abstracts deadlines? Specific themes?
 - Alex – we need as much time as possible to review and organise materials
 - Hard deadline – a minimum of a month before the conference

- Suggested using deadlines from the hotel bookings information (and own judgement)
- Payment to register?
 - Kiyoko confirmed that people do need to pay to register
- Early bird registration discounts?
 - Kiyoko confirmed the early bird registration is cheaper
 - Registration can stay open after the abstract deadlines have passed
 - Use a soft deadline first, then advertise that the deadline is being extended (hard deadline)
- Lauren – advertising and comms?
 - Alex will attend meeting with Lauren, Rasa, Wylan, and Matt
 - Suggested first meeting should focus on branding (photos, colours, hashtags, etc.)
 - Then agree on announcements and timelines, formats, etc.
 - Kiyoko suggested using the colour red strategically
 - Alex suggested darkening the red a little bit
 - Use AI to help generate hex code colour palette
 - Harry suggested using red as an accent colour

Meeting adjourned at 11:29 AM.